3 1 had obtained a copy for my parents, which I had autographed, and I could see that my father felt that I had fulfilled all his hopes at last. I think it was then he finally forgave me my failure to get into medical school ten years before. And after all, I was in medical school, wasn't I? And as a faculty member! 4 Up to this point I have carefully listed every check I received, but from here on it it would be far too complicated to do so. I will mention important ones if they play a role in my life, but otherwise not. I will, however, continue to give my annual income, since its ups and downs influenced the course of events.

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one allowed for inflation. With books in the works I hoped to do still better in the coming year.

*3

On January 2, 1950, I celebrated my thirtieth birthday after returning to Somerville that day. Once again I had a birthday in a new place.

Since this was a particularly significant birthday (I was thirty), I took the trouble to summarize my writing production in my diary. I had published forty-four stories in the magazines, of which six had been reprinted in anthologies (four hard-cover, two soft-cover). One more magazine story, "The Evitable Conflict," was in press, and two more of my already published stories were to be anthologized shortly. And, of course, there was my one book about to be published, and two more in preparation.

It wasn't bad for a hobby, but I still didn't dream it could be my profession.

As for my instructorship, which I then considered my real profession, the halcyon days of the first half year of the Medical School were drawing to a close.

The biochemistry course was given to the freshman class in the second semester. In the first semester, the class took anatomy chiefly, and while that first semester endured, the biochemistry professors could engage in research and in all sorts of ancillary activities—and that's what I had been doing since I arrived.

The last week in January, however, meant the beginning of the teaching semester, and I had never done any teaching. There came a time when Dr. Walker called a meeting of the department and divided the lectures among the